

Graduation

All students expecting to graduate must apply to graduate.

Graduation application deadlines are scheduled well in advance of the date of commencement to allow time for commencement preparation. Students who submit applications after the stated deadline cannot be guaranteed a diploma dated for that graduation, and cannot be assured inclusion in the graduation program or ceremony. Graduation applications are accepted only for students who have previously submitted to and had approved by the Office of Graduate Studies the appropriate advisor/thesis committee (thesis students only), Degree Audit form (all students), and Admission to Candidacy form (PhD candidates only) as applicable to the degree sought. Students earning more than one degree must submit the appropriate forms for each degree and apply to graduate for each degree.

Graduation Requirements

Registration

To graduate, students must be registered during the term in which they complete their program.

An exception to this registration policy allows students to complete an early checkout in the spring graduation semester if all requirements have been successfully met by a particular deadline.

For additional information, refer to <https://www.mines.edu/graduate-studies/graduation-deadlines/>.

Check-out

All graduating students must officially check out of their degree program. Students will be enrolled in a graduation check-out course after the student has applied to graduate. Students must follow the directions and complete the course by the established deadline.

Awarding Degrees

The awarding of a degree is contingent upon the student's successful completion of all program requirements with at least a 3.000 cumulative GPA before the date of graduation. Students who fail to graduate at the time originally anticipated must reapply for the next graduation before the appropriate deadline date stated on the Graduate School webpage.

Students who have completed all their degree requirements at least four weeks prior to the standard checkout deadline for their graduation date can, if necessary, request a letter from the Graduate Office certifying the completion of their programs. The student must have applied to graduate for the current or next graduation, met all the degree requirements, and have no holds. Note, the diploma and transcripts will show the date of the actual graduation, and the degree will not show as being awarded until after degrees have been awarded for that term.

Degrees for all students will be awarded within 10 business days after the commencement ceremony of the term in which the student applied to graduate, or for August graduates, 10 business days after the last day of the full summer term.

Commencement

Commencements are held in December and May. Students graduating in August may walk in the December graduation ceremony. Students eligible to graduate at these times are expected to attend their respective graduation exercises and must apply to graduate by the stated deadlines to be eligible to walk in the appropriate commencement ceremony. Students who do not apply to graduate by the stated deadlines may not be allowed to walk in the commencement ceremony. The exception is that non-thesis students graduating in August may be allowed to walk in the May ceremony if all of the following are met: the student has fewer than 6 credits to complete in the summer; the student has applied to graduate in May; and the student has consulted with the Mines Commencement Director about the exception. Students in thesis-based degree programs may not participate in graduation ceremonies before completing all degree requirements. Questions should be directed to commencement.mines.edu/.

Diplomas, Certificates, Transcripts, and Letters of Completion

Diplomas, certificates, transcripts, and letters of completion will not be released by the school for any student or graduate who has an unsettled obligation of any kind to the school. Diplomas and transcripts will be available through the Registrar's Office after degrees have been awarded. Students who check out early may request a Letter of Completion from the Graduate Office, but these letters will only be sent if requested at least four weeks prior to the commencement ceremony. Requests for a Letter of Completion after that time will not be accepted, so students will need to order the diploma or transcripts, as needed.